

GLOBAL ACCOUNTING PLATFORM

Detailed V1 Build Specification

Screen • Field • Action • State • Rule • Permission • Data • Acceptance

Scope: all 14 pre-release phases. Online payment gateways and live bank feeds are deferred; manual payment recording and statement import remain in V1.

1. Build Rules

- Ledger-first: finalized financial documents post through the accounting engine; reports derive from posted ledger data.
- Multi-tenant: every tenant-owned record is organization-scoped and cross-tenant access is a release-blocking defect.
- Posted records are immutable in substance; corrections use void, reversal, credit/debit adjustment or authorized journal flows.
- Money uses fixed-precision decimal values with currency-aware rounding.
- Every critical screen defines loading, empty, error, no-permission, archived/void and success states.
- Every financial mutation emits an audit event and, where applicable, a posting event.
- Payments in V1 are recorded, allocated and reconciled manually; no gateway checkout or payment-provider dependency.

2. Shared Screen Patterns

Pattern	Required elements
List	Title, quick-create, search, saved filters/views, status/date/customer filters, sortable columns, bulk actions, pagination, export, column settings
Create/Edit	Header, required-field markers, autosave/draft policy, validation summary, contextual help, Save Draft, Submit/Approve/Issue depending on module
Detail	Status header, primary actions, totals, source/related docs, attachments, comments, accounting impact, audit timeline
Import	Upload → map columns → validate → preview → import → result/error file
Approval	Submitter, amount/context, approval chain, comments, approve/reject/resubmit, history
Report	Date/basis filters, currency, dimensions/tags, comparison, drill-down, export, save/schedule

3. Phase 1 — Foundation

Screen	Core fields/actions	Rules / acceptance
Sign up	Name, email, password/SSO hook, terms; verify email	Rate-limited; verified identity required before organization creation
Organization setup	Legal/trading name, country, base currency, timezone, fiscal year, business type	Base currency becomes protected after posted activity; country drives defaults, not hard-coded rules
Tax setup	Tax regime, registration status, tax ID, inclusive/exclusive default	Tax definitions versioned; custom tax allowed where country pack permits
Numbering	Prefix, next number, padding per document type	Issued numbers unique within organization/document sequence; never reused
Users	Invite, role, status, resend/revoke	Only authorized users manage membership; invitation expiry and audit
Roles	Module/action matrix; segmented access hooks	Owner protected; custom roles cannot grant privileges creator lacks
Fiscal periods	Year, periods, close/lock state	Locked periods reject posting except authorized controlled unlock
Currencies	Base + enabled currencies, precision, rate source/manual rate	Transaction captures applied rate snapshot
Audit log	Actor, action, object, timestamp, source/IP metadata where appropriate	Append-only to tenant users; exportable by authorized role

Foundation data objects

- organizations
- organization_members
- roles
- role_permissions
- countries

- currencies
- exchange_rates
- tax_regimes
- tax_rates
- fiscal_years
- accounting_periods
- number_sequences
- audit_events

4. Phase 2 — Sales

Screen	Fields / actions	States & business rules
Customers	Type, display/legal name, email/phone, billing/shipping addresses, tax IDs, currency, terms, receivable account, tags	Active/inactive; customer currency defaults documents but may be overridden with permission
Quotes	Customer, dates, expiry, currency/rate, lines, tax, discount, notes, terms, attachments	Draft → Pending Approval → Approved → Sent → Accepted/Declined/Expired → Converted
Sales Orders	Customer, order date, expected date, lines, tax, references	Draft → Approved → Confirmed → Partially Fulfilled → Fulfilled/Cancelled
Invoices	Customer, invoice/date/due date, PO/ref, currency/rate, lines, tax, discount, shipping/adjustment, notes, terms	Draft → Approval → Issued/Sent → Partially Paid → Paid/Overdue/Void; issue posts AR/revenue/tax
Recurring Invoices	Template, customer, cadence, start/end, next run, auto-create/send flags	Scheduler idempotent; child invoices individually auditable
Credit Notes	Customer, source invoice optional, lines/tax/reason	Draft → Issued → Applied/Refund-recorded/Void; cannot over-allocate
Payments Received	Customer, date, amount, currency, method, reference, deposit account, invoice allocations	May be unapplied/partially applied/applied; posts cash/bank vs AR
Statements	Customer, period, opening balance, transactions, closing balance	Generated from AR subledger; totals reconcile to customer balance

Invoice line editor

Field	Rule
Item/service	Optional free-description mode configurable
Description	Snapshot copied to document
Quantity	Decimal > 0 unless credit/adjustment flow explicitly allows otherwise
Unit price	Fixed precision; price list/default may prefill
Discount	Line or document-level according to organization setting
Tax	Rate/exemption captured as snapshot
Account	Revenue account default from item; override permission-controlled
Project/tag	Optional dimensions for reporting

5. Phase 3 — Purchases

Screen	Fields/actions	Rules
Vendors	Identity, contacts, tax IDs, currency, payment terms, payable account	Active/inactive; duplicate warning
Purchase Orders	Vendor, dates, currency, lines, tax, delivery info	Draft → Approval → Issued → Partially Received/Billed → Closed/Cancelled
Bills	Vendor, bill no., dates, due date, lines/accounts, tax, attachments	Posting credits AP and debits expense/inventory/asset/tax accounts
Expenses	Payee/vendor, date, paid-through account, category/account, amount, tax, receipt	Can represent immediately-paid spend; approval configurable
Recurring Bills/Expenses	Template + schedule	Idempotent generation and failure reporting
Vendor Credits	Vendor, source bill, reason, lines	Apply against open bills; no over-allocation
Payments Made	Vendor, account, amount, method/reference, allocations	Posts AP debit and cash/bank credit

6. Phase 4 — Accounting Engine

Screen/engine	Specification	Acceptance
Chart of Accounts	Code, name, type, subtype, parent, currency where applicable, system flag, active	System/control accounts protected; inactive accounts remain historical
Manual Journal	Date, reference, memo, lines: account, debit/credit, contact, tax/dimension	Total debit = total credit before posting
Recurring Journal	Template + cadence + start/end	Generated entries unique per schedule occurrence
Posting Engine	Source event → validated posting rule → journal entry/lines	Atomic; idempotent; source-to-ledger traceable
Opening Balances	Accounts, AR/AP contacts, inventory opening where relevant	Balanced import required before finalize
Period Close	Review → soft close → lock; authorized unlock with reason	No unauthorized backdated posting
FX Revaluation	Foreign monetary balances at reporting rate	Difference posted to configured FX gain/loss accounts
Trial Balance	Account opening, debit, credit, closing	Debits equal credits at every cutoff

Canonical posting examples

Business event	Debit	Credit
Invoice issue	Accounts Receivable	Revenue + Tax Payable
Customer payment	Bank/Cash	Accounts Receivable
Bill posting	Expense/Inventory/Asset + Recoverable Tax	Accounts Payable
Vendor payment	Accounts Payable	Bank/Cash
Inventory cost on sale	Cost of Goods Sold	Inventory Asset
Credit note	Revenue/Tax reversal	Accounts Receivable/customer credit

7. Phase 5 — Banking & Reconciliation

Screen	Fields/actions	Rules
Accounts	Name, type, currency, GL mapping, opening balance	One GL mapping; account currency protected after activity
Statement Import	CSV first; adapter hooks for OFX/QIF; date, description, amount/debit-credit, reference	Mapping preview; duplicate fingerprint; failed rows downloadable
Transactions	Match, categorize, split, transfer, exclude with reason	Match cannot double-allocate source transaction
Bank Rules	Conditions on description/amount/reference → category/contact/tag suggestion	Rules suggest or auto-apply only if organization enables it
Reconciliation	Statement start/end, opening/closing balance, cleared transactions	Difference must be zero to complete; completed reconciliation locked
Transfers	From/to accounts, date, amount, FX/rate if currencies differ	Creates balanced transfer posting and linked banking records

8. Phase 6 — Inventory

Screen	Fields/actions	Rules
Items	Type, SKU, name, unit, sales/purchase rates/accounts, tax defaults, inventory tracking	Service/non-stock items do not create stock movements
Warehouses	Name, code, address/status	Stock movements always identify warehouse when inventory tracked
Stock Movements	Item, warehouse, qty, source, date, cost layer/reference	Append-only derived movement history
Adjustments	Qty/value adjustment, reason, account, attachment	Approval configurable; posts inventory difference
Transfers	Source/destination warehouse, item quantities	Net organization stock unchanged
Reorder	Threshold, preferred vendor, suggested quantity	Advisory; does not auto-purchase in V1
Valuation	Organization-selected supported valuation method	Inventory report reconciles to inventory control account

9. Phase 7 — Projects & Time

Screen	Fields/actions	Rules
Projects	Customer, name, dates, billing method, budget, status, manager	Open/On Hold/Completed/Cancelled
Tasks	Project, name, assignee, estimate, billable default	Task inherits project access
Timesheets	Date, project/task, user, hours, billable, rate, note	Submitted time immutable until rejected/unlocked
Time Approval	Period/user/project, entries, approve/reject comment	Approved billable time eligible for invoice
Project Expenses	Linked expense, billable markup/rate	Cannot invoice same expense twice
Generate Invoice	Select approved unbilled time/expenses	Creates invoice lines with source links
Profitability	Revenue, billed/unbilled time, costs, expenses, margin	Drill-down to source records

10. Phase 8 — Globalization

Config	Required model
Country Pack	Version, status, supported entity types, default currency/timezone/fiscal rules
Tax Pack	Tax labels, rates, registration fields, inclusive/exclusive rules, exemptions, reporting mappings
Document Rules	Required legal fields, numbering constraints, labels, footer/legal text
Locale	Language key, date/number/address/phone formats
Structured Invoice	Canonical invoice JSON/XML-ready model separate from PDF
Compliance Status	Fully reviewed / generic configuration / unsupported; never imply compliance where unreviewed

Architecture must be ready for structured e-invoicing. OpenPeppol maintains country profiles across multiple regions, while the EU's ViDA implementation introduces cross-border B2B digital reporting from 1 July 2030. Country-specific compliance remains a legal/accounting review task, not merely a software toggle.

11. Phase 9 — Reporting

Report family	V1 reports
Financial	Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow, Trial Balance, General Ledger, Journal
Receivables	AR Aging Summary/Detail, Customer Balances, Invoice Details, Payments Received
Payables	AP Aging Summary/Detail, Vendor Balances, Bill Details, Payments Made
Sales	Sales by Customer, Item, Period, Salesperson/tag where configured
Purchases	Purchases/Expenses by Vendor, Category, Period
Tax	Tax Summary, Tax Detail, taxable/exempt bases, liability/recoverable views
Inventory	Stock on Hand, Valuation, Movements, Adjustments, Reorder
Projects	Time, Unbilled Time/Expenses, Revenue/Cost, Profitability
Audit	Transaction history, user activity, approvals, void/reversal history

Report behavior

- Cash/accrual view only where accounting logic supports it correctly
- Base-currency financial statements; transaction-currency drill-down
- Comparative periods
- Dimensions/tags
- Drill-through to source transactions
- CSV/XLSX/PDF export architecture
- Saved filters and scheduled delivery

12. Phase 10 — Automation & Approvals

Capability	Specification
Approvals	No approval / simple / multi-level / criteria-based
Approval targets	Quotes, sales orders, invoices, credit notes, POs, bills, payments made, inventory adjustments, journals as configured
Rules	Trigger + conditions + actions; permission-aware
Reminders	Before due / on due / overdue schedules; email template; stop when paid/void
Recurring engine	Invoices, bills, expenses, journals with idempotent occurrence keys
Notifications	In-app + email preference matrix
Scheduled reports	Report + recipients + cadence + format

The benchmark product supports module-level approvals, including simple, multi-level and custom approval flows; V1 should match the business need but use an independent implementation and UX. [cite](#) [turn0search10](#) [turn0search14](#)

13. Phase 11 — Portals & Collaboration

Surface	Capabilities
Customer Portal	View/download quotes, orders where exposed, invoices, credit notes, statements, receipts; accept/decline quotes; update permitted profile fields
Accountant Access	Dedicated role, multi-organization switcher, journals/reconciliation/reports/close permissions
Comments	Internal comments on transactions; optional customer-visible comments explicitly marked
Attachments	Upload/download with permissions and audit
Activity	Unified timeline of status, email, approval, accounting and user actions

14. Phase 12 — Platform Admin

Screen	Capabilities
Organizations	Search/filter, status, country, plan, usage, owner, created date; suspend/reactivate with safeguards
Users	Account status, memberships, security/support metadata
Plans & Entitlements	Feature flags, limits, trial, future billing fields; no payment billing integration required V1
Country Packs	Create/version/publish/deprecate configuration
Tax Definitions	Manage versioned global/local tax metadata
Feature Flags	Global/country/plan/tenant targeting
Jobs	Queue health, failed recurring jobs/imports/PDF/email jobs, retry
Security Events	Admin actions, privilege changes, suspicious events
Product Analytics	Activation, first invoice, reconciliation use, retention/module adoption

15. Phase 13 — AI Layer

Feature	V1 guardrail
Receipt extraction	Extract candidate vendor/date/amount/tax/category; user must review before creating/posting
Ask your books	Permission-filtered natural-language query over reporting/semantic layer
Explain a number	Trace answer to report rows and source transactions
Categorization suggestions	Suggestion only unless explicit user-approved rule exists
Variance/anomaly insights	Advisory, explainable and dismissible
Draft text	Descriptions/reminders only; no autonomous financial commitment

16. Phase 14 — Hardening & Release

Gate	Must pass
Accounting	Golden scenario suite; balanced ledger; subledger/control reconciliation; period locks; FX cases
Tenant isolation	Automated cross-org authorization tests across API, exports, portal and jobs
Security	Auth/session/MFA, rate limits, secret handling, dependency scanning, file validation, admin controls
Reliability	Backup restore drill, queue retry/idempotency, disaster procedures, observability
Performance	Large lists, imports and reports tested with production-like data volumes
Accessibility	Critical journeys keyboard-usable and WCAG 2.2 AA-oriented
Migration/import	Customers, vendors, items, opening balances and core transaction import paths tested
Operations	Monitoring, alerts, runbooks, support/admin tools ready
Launch	Terms/privacy/compliance claims reviewed; selected country packs signed off

17. Permission Matrix

Module	Owner/Admin	Accountant	Sales	Purchases	Inventory	Project	Viewer
Settings/Users	Manage	Limited	—	—	—	—	View*
Customers	Manage	View	Manage	View	View	View	View
Invoices	Manage	Manage	Manage	View	View	View	View
Vendors/Bills	Manage	Manage	View	Manage	View	View	View
Banking	Manage	Manage	—	—	—	—	View*
Accounting	Manage	Manage	—	—	—	—	View*
Inventory	Manage	View	View	View	Manage	View	View
Projects/Time	Manage	View	View	View	View	Manage	View
Reports	Manage	Manage	Scoped	Scoped	Scoped	Scoped	View
Approvals	By policy	By policy	By policy	By policy	By policy	By policy	—

*Exact permissions are configurable. The table is a default-role baseline, not a hard-coded authorization model.

18. Cross-Module Acceptance Scenarios

1. Service business: create customer → quote → acceptance → invoice → partial payment → final payment → bank import/match → reconcile → P&L/AR/GL agree.
2. Retail business: purchase inventory → vendor bill → payment → stock receipt → sale/invoice → stock issue/COGS → customer payment → inventory valuation agrees to GL.
3. Project business: create project → approved time + expense → generate invoice → record payment → project profitability and ledger reconcile.
4. Credit flow: issue invoice → partial payment → credit note → allocate credit → remaining balance correct in statement, AR aging and GL.
5. Foreign currency: issue foreign invoice → payment at different rate → realized FX gain/loss posted and base-currency reports balance.
6. Close period: reconcile → lock → attempt backdated edit/post fails → authorized unlock records actor/reason → re-lock succeeds.
7. Approval: maker creates transaction → cannot issue before approval → approver rejects → maker edits/resubmits → approver approves → issue/post → history complete.
8. Tenant security: identical record IDs/guesses from another organization never disclose existence or data.

19. API & Event Contract Principles

- REST/JSON or equivalent typed API with organization context derived from authenticated membership, never trusted solely from client input.
- Create/update endpoints use optimistic concurrency/version fields for high-risk financial records.
- Posting endpoints accept idempotency keys.
- Domain events include invoice.issued, invoice.voided, payment.recorded, bill.posted, journal.posted, stock.moved, reconciliation.completed.
- Background consumers must be retry-safe and idempotent.
- Public API/webhooks can be exposed after internal contracts stabilize; V1 architecture should not require a public developer platform to launch.
- Future payment-provider adapters consume provider events and translate them into the existing payment/allocation service, never bypassing the ledger.

20. Build Sequence

1. Establish monorepo/repositories, environments, CI/CD, coding standards and design tokens.
2. Implement identity, tenancy and permissions.
3. Implement ledger schema/posting engine and automated accounting invariants before broad transaction UI.
4. Build Sales as first complete vertical slice from document to ledger/report.
5. Build Purchases as second complete vertical slice.
6. Add banking import/reconciliation.
7. Add inventory, then projects/time.
8. Complete country-pack/localization framework.
9. Complete reports and reconciliation tests.
10. Add automation/approvals and portals.
11. Add platform admin and guarded AI features.
12. Run hardening, migration, accountant validation, security and launch gates.

21. Benchmark Notes

Current Zoho Books documentation confirms a broad product model spanning quotes, sales orders, invoices, recurring invoices, credit notes, expenses, bills, purchase orders, vendor payments/credits, accounting, banking/reconciliation, approvals and time tracking. It also supports custom roles and segmented access. These are used only as functional benchmarks for completeness; this specification defines an independent product. [?cite?turn0search0?turn0search2?turn0search16?](#)

Zoho Books also allows invoices to be manually marked/recorded as paid, including partial payments, which validates the V1 decision to provide a complete receivables workflow without requiring online payment processing. [?cite?turn0search0?](#)

22. Definition of Done

- Every screen in this specification has approved UX designs and responsive states.
- Every action has a permission, validation, audit and accounting-impact definition.
- Every accounting-impacting transaction has tested posting and reversal rules.
- Every report has a source-of-truth definition and reconciliation test.
- Every background job has retry/idempotency behavior.
- Every module has seeded demo data, automated tests and acceptance scenarios.
- All 14 phases pass their release gates before public V1.